existence is naturally subject to destruction. So every element of existence is destroyed as soon as it comes into existence.

If this is true, there can be no real change. The Buddhists deny that something with a stable identity can change if change means becoming something else while staying the same thing but with different properties. There is no intrinsic change: only successive replacement.

The destruction of things is spontaneous because this is the nature of things. If something perishes by nature, it perishes on coming into existence. If something perishes on coming into existence, it is momentary. Thus there is no movement or change. There is only the arising of the next moment in many physical and mental series.

Further reading: Mookerjee 1975

Kumarila Bhatta (625–75 CE): a follower of the ***Purva Mimamsaka*** tradition, Kumarila was a realist philosopher whose major works include the *Shlokavarttika* and *Tantravarttika* commentaries on *Shabara*'s commentary on the *Mimamsa Sutras* of *Jaimini*.

A resolute opponent of Buddhism, *Kumarila* thinks that the individual soul (***atman***), really beyond space and time, is the centre of agency (*karta*) and experience (*bhokta*). Cognitions are formless (*nirakara*) acts. In each cognition, the non-creative mind is originally a blank slate (not a stock of concepts, memories and expectations conditioning the mode in which information is registered and interpreted) receiving information via the senses, about a world of objects. No possibly distorting inner realm of preconceptions intervenes between awareness and external objects. Cognitions are intrinsically truthful (***svatah pramanya***). That is to say, cognitions are assumed to be reliable. Even errors and dreams refer